

5.2 Search Me!

A ridiculous number of books have been written about it, but there are few things on the Web as arcane as Search Engine Optimisation (SEO)—you never know what’s going to boost your search engine ranking and when. SEO-ing your blog works better if you’re using your own hosting and content management system—the options available to you are far more comprehensive than free blog hosting. However, there are a few things you can do to enhance your free blog’s search ranking.

5.2.1 SEO-ing Your Free Blog

Firstly, let go of any illusions you might have that Blogger users are at an advantage just because Google owns Blogger. The following tips apply almost universally too:

1. Choose your blog and post titles appropriately. You’ll need something catchy to grab potential readers, but search engines would prefer that you include at least one keyword indicative of the post’s content in every post title.
2. Stick to a general theme for your blog. By their very nature, blogs are riddled with search keywords, and themed blogs more so.
3. Update your blog regularly. Search engines love the “live” Web—sites that are updated with new content on a regular basis.
4. Register yourself on every possible blog listing.
5. Exploit the power of being linked to—make comments on high-traffic blogs (not the I-like-your-site-you-might-like-mine kind, mind you), start discussions, and get yourself blogrolled on as many people’s blogs as possible.
6. Wherever available, always make sure that you have a permalink for each post—this helps search engines index them better.